WAI TING JACINDA SZE

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics Expected 2027
University of Delaware, Newark, DE
Dissertation: "Essays on Parental Co-Residence, Wealth, and Family Formation"
Related Coursework: Household Finance (Theory & Empirics), Cross-Section and Panel Data, Time Series Econometrics, Topics in Dynamic Modeling, Topics in Labor Economics, Workshop in Finance: Empirical, Benefit-Cost Analysis

M.S. Economics and Applied Econometrics 2022
University of Delaware, Newark, DE

B.A. Economics and Psychology 2020
CUNY Baruch College, New York, NY, *Summa Cum Laude*

FIELDS

Household Finance, Housing Economics, Family Economics, Consumption

RESEARCH

"The Dynamics of Co-Residence, Wealth, and Family Formation" (Job Market Paper)

Abstract: It has become increasingly common for adult children to live in their parents' home. This paper studies the causes and consequences of parental co-residence from the perspective of young adults using data from the Panel Study of Income Dynamics Transition to Adulthood Supplement. I employ event study methods and an instrumental variables approach based on state-level rental housing unaffordability and find three main results. First, event studies indicate that household finances are surprisingly disconnected from co-residence changes. Second, marriage and fertility are strongly associated with housing independence. Third, plausibly exogenous variation in rental housing unaffordability only modestly affects co-residence.

"Parental Co-Residence and Asset Accumulation"

Abstract: This paper develops and solves a model to examine how young adults' savings decisions are affected by co-residence and student loan payments. Co-residence is typically chosen by individuals are younger and have lower incomes, making it more challenging for them to save compared to those who do not co-reside. Additionally, young adults are more likely to co-reside when housing costs are high and their preference for independent living is low. The model predicts that without the obligation of rental payments, extra savings during co-residence are used to pay off student loans.

"Parental Co-Residence and Marital Transitions" (In Progress)

Abstract: A structural model is built to examine the relationship between parental co-residence and marriage timing. I study how living arrangements may delay marriage, incorporating housing costs, preferences for independence, and match quality.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, University of Delaware

ECON 483: The Economics of Jobs and Wages	Fall 2026
ECON 435: Public Finance and Public Policy	Fall 2026
ECON 304: Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory with Calculus	Fall 2026
ECON 423: Applications of Modern Econometrics	Spring 2026 (2nd half)
ECON 300: Intermediate Microeconomic Theory Without Calculus	Spring 2026 (2nd half)
ECON 101: Introduction to Microeconomics	Spring 2025
ECON 306: Introduction to Econometrics	Fall 2023, Spring 2021, Fall 2020
ECON 823: Econometric Theory II (Ph.D. level)	Spring 2022
ECON 822: Econometric Theory I (Ph.D. level)	Fall 2021

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, University of Delaware

Professor Tom Eisenberg — Fall 2024, Spring 2024, Spring 2023

Cleaned and structured coal mine data using Stata to create a reliable dataset for future analysis.

Professor Olga Gorbachev — Fall 2022

Applied difference-in-differences models to analyze financial institution visit patterns.

Intern, Econometrix Research Associates, Inc. — Summer 2019

Supported preliminary economic damage analysis by reviewing depositions and replicating damage valuations to verify accuracy.

PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

Innovative Teaching Strategies, IT-Academic Technology Services, University of Delaware — 2025

SKILLS

Software: Stata, GitHub, LaTeX, Python

REFERENCES

Hans Holter (Main Advisor)
Associate Professor of Economics
University of Delaware
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Tom Eisenberg
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Matthew White
Principal Developer
Econ-ARK
mnwhite@gmail.com